



SHIVAY BHANDARI

Comedy Acts

Because they taught British Asians to laugh at themselves with *Goodness Gracious Me* and *The Kumars at No. 42* and when the equal opportunity comics don't get work, they write their own.

Because she is an MBE and he is an OBE and together they have become the It Couple among British Asians, with a new TV series for her and a chancellorship of University of Sussex for him.

Did you know?

She was edited out of Woody Allen's *Scoop* though she showed up for the shoot heavily pregnant.



MEERA SYAL & SANJEEV BHASKAR

18

48 and 45,
Writers, Actors

GETTY IMAGES

JHUMPA LAHIRI

19

42, Author

American Beauty



Did you know?

Her real name is Nilanjana Sudeshna Lahiri. Jhumpa was her nickname, easier for American teachers to remember.

AP

Because she is the gold standard against which America judges subcontinental writing and her *Unaccustomed Earth* debuted at an astonishing No. 1 on *The New York Times* bestseller list.

Because not only is she the thinking man's sex symbol (TMSS), No. 8 out of a list of 10 TMSSs, according to Tina Brown's feisty *Daily Beast*, but also the hard-to-please *New York Post* put her at No. 32 in a list of 50 Most Powerful Women in New York City.

Because she has become the mistress of the Kleenex moment and has made the Bengali-American experience part of several liberal arts programmes in America.